

Weekly Project Progress Report

Team Name: [MedCare Team](#)

Week Number: [Week12](#)

Team Members: [Aya Ali](#), [Mlaak Al-Shawa](#), [Lama Alhaj](#)

Work completed this week

This week, we carried out extensive testing and implemented vital security audits for the MedCare System. We hardened user sessions against fixation attacks and secured cookie options. We also updated the authorization guards to redirect unauthorized users back to their own specific role dashboards with error warning banners, preventing redirection loops. In addition, we introduced format check helpers to validate input date strings (DOB, booking dates) in PHP model methods, and escaped dynamic outputs using `htmlspecialchars` to prevent XSS.

Features implemented

We completed the security and testing requirements. Key integrations include dynamic session id regeneration on login and secure session cookies settings. We added access control warnings to the patient, doctor, and admin dashboards triggered by the error parameter. We also integrated the date validation constraint on backend inputs (rejecting past dates for scheduling or bad input formats) and audited database escape functions. All pages (BookAppointment, AdminDashboard, DoctorDashboard, Login, Register, MyAppointment, and PatientDashboard) were fully tested and validated.

Problems encountered

We encountered redirection loops when logged-in users trying to bypass security to access restricted pages were routed to the login index, which in turn routed them back to their dashboard. We also analyzed date input edge cases where clients bypass input type attributes to submit text formats.

Solutions applied

We refactored our authorization checking function to redirect unauthorized logged-in users directly to their own dashboard with a clear `error=unauthorized` query string, which renders a warning alert banner. We also implemented a date format and range check inside model creation/update functions, ensuring that past dates are rejected for booking.

Plan for next week

On the next week (Week 13), we will prepare the final product, compile the walkthrough guidelines, record a project demonstration video, and complete the final submission report.

Questions for instructor

Are there any specific formatting or duration requirements for the final presentation video?